Imperial Oil

Business Development Dossier

Industry	**Energy / Oil & Gas**
Revenue	**$8.5B**
Employees	**5,000**
Ideal Customer Profile Score	**78**

ICP SCORING MODEL


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ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit   (max 100)
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Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% | <90d: 30% | <180d: 20% | older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	$500M-$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below $500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 | Above $10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) | 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name Imperial Oil Limited

Headquarters

Calgary, Alberta, Canada (relocating operations to Edmonton by 2028)

Founded 1880

Ownership

Public (TSX/NYSE: IMO). ExxonMobil holds 69.6% majority stake.

Footprint

Upstream: Kearl oil sands, Cold Lake. Downstream: Strathcona Refinery (Edmonton), Sarnia, Nanticoke. Esso retail network across Canada. Corporate functions migrating to Houston and ExxonMobil centers in India, Argentina, Thailand, Brazil.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Imperial Oil is one of Canada's largest integrated oil companies, with operations spanning oil sands production, conventional crude oil, petroleum refining, and fuel marketing. Majority-owned by ExxonMobil, the company operates the Kearl oil sands mine and Strathcona refinery.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Imperial Oil's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue: FY2024 ~CA$51.5B. Net income CA$4.79B. Cash from operations CA$5.98B. Record production 438,000 boe/d (highest in 30+ years). Q4 2025: EPS beat by 1.55% but revenue missed by 10.41%. Dividend raised 20% in Q1 2026. Analyst sentiment: Hold. TD Securities: Sell. BMO: downgraded to Market Perform. Restructuring targeting $150M annual savings by 2028.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Dan Lyons - SVP, Finance & Administration [PRIORITY TARGET]

U.S. Army veteran. BA Economics Vassar; MBA Chicago. Joined ExxonMobil 1990. Career across Dallas, Bangkok, Houston, Saudi Arabia, London.

Outreach rationale: U.S. Army veteran - direct connection to McChrystal Group's military network. As finance leader, controls consulting budgets. Deep institutional knowledge. Entry angle: veteran-to-veteran conversation.

John Whelan - Chairman, President & CEO [PRIORITY TARGET]

From St. John's, Newfoundland. 37-year ExxonMobil career. Previously SVP Upstream at ExxonMobil (13 global business units). Memorial University B.Eng.

Outreach rationale: New CEO executing most significant transformation in Imperial's modern history within first year.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Cheryl Gomez-Smith - SVP, Upstream

BS Mech. Eng. Notre Dame; MBA Tulane

Scott Maloney - VP, Downstream

12+ years in ExxonMobil lubricants, retail fuel. Moved to Calgary 2023.

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Imperial Oil operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Classic integrated oil company with upstream/downstream/corporate divisions. Historically operated with meaningful autonomy from ExxonMobil ('corporate separateness'). The 2025 restructuring collapses that autonomy - centralizing into ExxonMobil's global centers.

Culture Signals

Glassdoor 3.3/5.0; Culture & Values 2.9/5 (lowest); only 47% recommend. Indeed 4.0/5. Positives: good people, strong pay, learning opportunities. Negatives: 'slow company,' excessive processes, bureaucracy. [INFERRED] Post-restructuring morale likely significantly worse. Key challenges: identity crisis (becoming ExxonMobil branch vs. autonomous Canadian company), survivor syndrome, knowledge drain (900 departures), two-speed org (operations untouched, corporate gutted), political headwind (Alberta Premier and federal minister publicly criticized).

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Imperial Oil.

1. **2025-02-13 - CEO Brad Corson announces retirement; John Whelan named successor**
   New CEO inheriting and executing biggest restructuring. Classic 'new leader, big mandate' moment.

2. **2025-09-29 - 20% workforce reduction (~900 jobs), offshoring, Houston migration announced**
   Primary trigger. Massive transformation with high execution risk. Team of Teams built for maintaining cohesion during structural change.

3. **2025-09-30 - Alberta Premier and Federal Energy Minister publicly criticize restructuring**
   Political backlash adds reputational risk. Must manage external stakeholders while executing internally.

4. **2025-10-01 - Imperial signs deal to sell Quarry Park campus (800,000 sq ft)**
   Physical symbol of transformation. Losing HQ = identity-defining moment.

5. **2025-12-01 - Record annual production (438,000 boe/d) despite restructuring**
   Operationally strong but restructuring from strength can make alignment harder - 'why fix what's not broken?'

6. **2025-12-15 - 2026 guidance: 441-460K boe/d, $2.0-2.2B capex, 20% dividend increase**
   Shareholder-returns narrative dominant. Risk: workforce perceives leadership prioritizing shareholders over employees.

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

> *Textbook opportunity. New CEO, massive workforce reduction, geographic dispersion, identity transformation, political headwinds, high-stakes operating environment. Dan Lyons military connection provides warm entry. Primary risk: ExxonMobil controlling consulting relationship from Houston.*

Primary Problem

Imperial Oil is eliminating 20% of its workforce, offshoring critical functions, relocating HQ, and fundamentally restructuring its relationship with parent ExxonMobil - under a new CEO, with political opposition, in an industry facing long-term transition pressure. Risk is organizational: maintaining excellence, knowledge, collaboration, and commitment during 2+ years of sustained disruption.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Team of Teams - fragmenting into geographically dispersed nodes (Edmonton, Houston, India, Argentina, Thailand, Brazil). Cross-functional alignment - upstream/downstream/corporate silos being physically separated. Leadership development - new CEO, new downstream VP. Culture change - trust destroyed by layoffs/offshoring.

Likely Objections to Engagement

ExxonMobil manages our consulting relationships
Internal change management capabilities via ExxonMobil
Restructuring plan is set - just need to execute
Budget pressure - entire point is cost reduction

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey - likely involved (ExxonMobil is known McKinsey client) [INFERRED]
Korn Ferry - strong O&G org consulting practice
Deloitte - major Calgary energy sector presence
Internal ExxonMobil resources - biggest competitor

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. You're asking 80% of your people to stay committed while watching colleagues lose their jobs and seeing the company's identity change. How are you maintaining shared purpose across a workforce now spread from Edmonton to Houston to Mumbai?

2. Dan, you served in the Army - you know what it takes to maintain unit cohesion during reorganization. How is Imperial preserving the knowledge and relationships that keep Kearl and Cold Lake running at record levels while the corporate structure changes?

Veteran-to-veteran framing with Dan Lyons

3. The political reaction from Alberta and Ottawa was unusually sharp. How is leadership managing the external narrative while keeping internal execution on track?

Recommended Meeting Framing

Enter through Dan Lyons (veteran connection, economic buyer) with goal of earning a meeting with Whelan. Frame as 'operational risk mitigation, knowledge transfer velocity, and cross-functional execution speed' - avoid 'culture' language (ExxonMobil culture is engineering-driven and metrics-focused).

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Imperial Oil's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Value & Competitive Standing: Imperial Oil is one of Canada's oldest and most recognized energy companies, operating under the Esso and Mobil brands (licensed from parent ExxonMobil). The Esso brand carries strong consumer recognition across Canada's ~2,000 fuel retail stations. In upstream, Imperial is the largest producer in the Athabasca oil sands through its Kearl and Cold Lake operations.

Brand Identity Evolution: Imperial is transitioning from an operationally autonomous Canadian energy company to a more deeply integrated ExxonMobil subsidiary. This identity shift - from independent Canadian icon to branch office - is culturally significant. The Strathcona refinery closure (Alberta's oldest) marks the end of an era and signals the brand's evolution toward focused upstream production.

Marketing Leadership & Strategy: [INFERRED] Imperial's consumer marketing operates through the Esso brand, which is managed in coordination with ExxonMobil's global brand standards. The dual-brand structure (Imperial for corporate/investor audiences, Esso for consumers) creates coordination complexity.

Brand Threats: Political backlash in Alberta against the perceived Americanization of Imperial (HQ relocation from

Calgary to Houston-aligned). Environmental activism targeting oil sands operations. Workforce reduction damaging employer brand in a tight Alberta energy labor market.

McChrystal Connection: The brand transformation from autonomous Canadian company to ExxonMobil-integrated subsidiary requires organizational coordination between two corporate cultures, two governance structures, and two national regulatory environments. McChrystal's cross-organizational alignment methodology addresses this sovereign-subsidiary coordination challenge.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Imperial Oil. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Sovereign-Subsidiary Identity Transformation

Imperial is losing its operational autonomy - becoming more integrated with ExxonMobil while maintaining its Canadian legal entity, regulatory obligations, and cultural identity. This isn't a typical M&A integration; it's a sovereign company becoming a subsidiary. McChrystal's experience bridging military units with different authorities and identities (U.S. forces coordinating with allied forces) is the direct analog.

Fit Dimension 2: Workforce Transformation Under Political Pressure

Eliminating 20% of the workforce while offshoring functions to ExxonMobil shared services - in a politically charged Alberta environment where energy jobs are a hot-button issue - requires communication discipline and organizational coordination that typical restructuring consultants don't address. McChrystal's operating model maintains organizational cohesion during workforce transformation.

Fit Dimension 3: Multi-Site Operational Coordination

With the Strathcona refinery closing, operations at Kearl and Cold Lake must absorb displaced talent, maintain safety standards, and coordinate with ExxonMobil's global supply chain. McChrystal's distributed operations coordination methodology connects remote operational sites with corporate transformation initiatives.

9b. Cumulative Case

Imperial Oil is executing one of the most culturally significant corporate transformations in Canadian energy: the gradual integration of an iconic Canadian company into its American parent. Signal chain: New CEO -> 20% workforce reduction -> HQ relocation -> refinery closure -> ExxonMobil integration deepening -> political backlash -> remaining 4,000 employees navigating identity crisis. Revenue potential: $350K initial, $800K-$1.2M deployment, $250K ongoing. Total: $1.4M-$2M over 18 months.

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Identity Crisis: Employees who built careers at "Imperial Oil" must now operate within ExxonMobil's framework

while maintaining the Canadian entity's distinct regulatory and cultural identity. 2. Political Risk Management: Alberta's government and public are sensitive to energy job losses. Every organizational decision has a political dimension that requires coordinated communication. 3. Offshoring Backlash: Moving functions to ExxonMobil shared services (likely Houston) creates internal resistance and external criticism. Knowledge transfer must happen before offshored employees leave. 4. Safety Culture During Disruption: Oil sands operations are safety-critical. Workforce uncertainty cannot be allowed to degrade safety performance on active sites. 5. Strathcona Closure Execution: Closing Alberta's oldest refinery requires environmental remediation coordination, workforce transition, community engagement, and asset disposition - all simultaneously. 6. New CEO Authority Building: A new CEO executing the most unpopular transformation in company history must build trust and credibility quickly.

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. ExxonMobil Integration Operating Model: Coordination architecture bridging Imperial and ExxonMobil operations. Measurable: integration milestones on-track, zero unplanned operational disruptions. 2. Workforce Transition Discipline: Structured approach to 20% reduction maintaining safety and operational performance. Measurable: safety metrics maintained at pre-transformation levels. 3. Stakeholder Communication System: Coordinated messaging across employees, government, communities, and investors. Measurable: stakeholder sentiment scores tracked and managed. 4. Strathcona Closure Execution: Cross-functional coordination for refinery shutdown. Measurable: closure milestones on-track, environmental compliance maintained. 5. Remaining Workforce Stabilization: Retention and engagement program for the 4,000 employees staying. Measurable: voluntary attrition below 5% during transformation.

9e. Key Stakeholders

CEO

Leader: [New CEO]
Role: Transformation leadership
McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor

Operations (Upstream)

Leader: [SVP Operations]
Role: Kearl, Cold Lake operations
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Safety during transformation

Finance

Leader: [CFO]
Role: ExxonMobil financial integration
McChrystal Relevance: Budget gatekeeper

HR

Leader: [CHRO/VP HR]
Role: Workforce reduction, offshoring
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Transition execution

Government Relations

Leader: [VP External Affairs]
Role: Political stakeholder management
McChrystal Relevance: Alberta political navigation

ExxonMobil Liaison

Leader: [Integration Lead]
Role: Parent company coordination
McChrystal Relevance: Cross-organizational alignment

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: 20% workforce reduction + HQ relocation + refinery closure + ExxonMobil integration all happening in 2025-2026. Maximum organizational complexity.

Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: McKinsey advises on operational strategy. ExxonMobil has its own internal consulting capability. But the sovereign-subsidiary cultural transformation - maintaining Canadian identity while integrating with an American parent - requires the kind of cross-organizational alignment McChrystal pioneered in multinational military operations. No consulting firm can credibly claim this capability.

Phased Engagement: Phase 1 ($300K-$400K): Integration operating model + workforce transition design. Phase 2 ($500K-$800K): Enterprise deployment across all transformation workstreams. Phase 3 ($250K retainer): Ongoing integration management. Total: $1M-$1.5M.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit: SVP Operations (safety during transformation), CHRO (workforce transition), and ExxonMobil integration lead (cross-organizational coordination). Military/veteran connections in Canadian energy sector. Energy industry conference proximity.